



Mrs. Harimaya Khatiwada of Siddhalekh Rural Municipality, ward no. 6, Samitar in Dhading district. She has received NPR. 300,000 as a GoN grant.

Left: Mrs. Khatiwada's newly constructed two-roomed RCC house.

Right: Her one-roomed stone in mud masonry (SMM) that was damaged by the Gorkha earthquake. She has not demolished her house and it is still being used as a cowshed and for storage.

This digital video story highlights issues, challenges related to Guthi land in the urban reconstruction setting. The beneficiaries living in Guthi land including all other concerned stakeholders such as Guthi owners, ward chairpersons, Palikas and NRA need to work together to resolve Guthi land issues.



HIGHLIGHTS

- [International Conference update](#)
- [MIS Digitization Training for DSE, M&E and Focal Engineer](#)
- [Public notice pertaining to non-beneficiary](#)
- **Orientation on preparation of institutional papers for international conference on Nepal's reconstruction**
- **Urban Sharing Session**
- Updates from Retrofitting Working Group (R-TWG)

FEATURED TECHNICAL STAFF PERSON



Er. Kriti Gyawali
Focal Engineer
Kathmandu Metropolitan City

Featured Technical staff person, Kriti Gyawali,

After the massive earthquake of April 2015 that caused a huge loss of life and property, and affected lives of around 800,000 people, the National Reconstruction Authority was established with the concept of Build Back Better (3Bs). Among those affected by the earthquake 7,500 were identified as potential beneficiaries in Kathmandu Metropolitan City. To cope with the high demand of reconstruction and assist the beneficiaries, NRA appointed many Technicians and Engineers to facilitate private housing reconstruction work. I have been one of those lucky Engineers to be serving the earthquake affected people to build resilient houses, said Kriti.

Prior to working in Kathmandu Metropolitan City, Kriti was assigned to a rural area of Tanahun district where she worked for a duration of 3 months as an Engineer. Then she was transferred to Kathmandu Metropolitan City where she has been actively engaged as a Focal Engineer since April 2018 and is working dedicatedly in urban housing development.

PHOTO FEATURE



Ward 5, Mahankal Rural Municipality, Lalitpur: Load bearing stone in mud mortar, single storey with two rooms, and light CGI sheet.

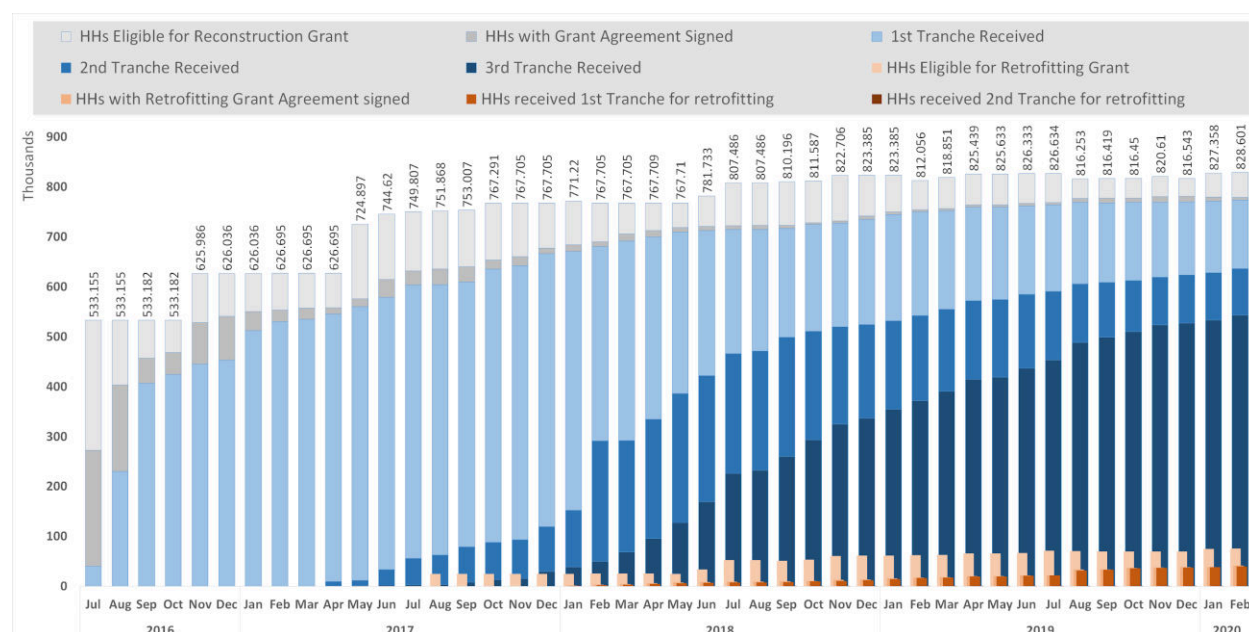


Ward 9, Khadadevi Rural Municipality, Ramechhap: The beneficiary is a retrofit beneficiary who has filed for change in beneficiary type and has dismantled her retrofit eligible house and started reconstructing a new house. The first tranche is currently under process.

NATIONAL UPDATES

NRA, CLPIU GMaLI and Building Grant Disbursement Data, as of 24 February 2020:

Reconstruction Grant	30 December	27 January	24 February
Total No. Eligible HHs	816543	827358	828601
HHs Enrolled	780803	779125	778253
HHs Received 1st Tranche	769929	770861	773058
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	637348	639554	643431
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	622930	627909	635750
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	3223	3188	3154
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	549740	553777	557818
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	526968	532805	542597
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	1941	1949	1962
Houses Completed	481761	482794	484542
HHs with Completion Certificate	60859	77338	80718
Retrofit Grant	30 December	27 January	24 February
Total No. Eligible HHs	69614	74678	75435
HHs Enrolled	38101	38399	41166
HHs Received 1st Tranche	37668	37872	39520
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	34	36	43



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMaLI CLPIU data as of 24 February 2020.

International Conference update: The NRA has a tentative plan to organize an international conference in November 2020 with the objective of sharing Nepal's experience on emergency response and reconstruction and learn from global experiences in earthquake risk reduction. In this regard, NRA is currently scanning abstract papers that were submitted to the International Conference Secretariat and are being reviewed for further research action and subsequent publication process. Partners have been requested to submit institutional reports on the good practices of emergency response and reconstruction as well. For more information contact: conference@nra.gov.np or reconstnra@gmail.com For more detail information, please refer to the [website](#) or contact Mr. Manohar Ghimire, Under Secretary, (9848126559) email: mghimire@nra.gov.np

MIS Digitization Training for DSE, M&E and Focal Engineer: CLPIU-Building has circulated an invitation letter to DLPIU-Building Offices of Okhaldhunga, Sindhuli, Dolakha, Ranechap, Sindhupalchowk, Kavrepalanchowk, Bhaktapur, Kathmandu, Lalitpur, Makawanpur, Rasuwa, Nuwakot, Dhading, Gorkha, Lamjung, Kaski, Baglung, Palpa, Chitwan and Dhankuta (20

districts), requesting them to send DSE, M&E and Focal Engineer to participate in the [MIS digitization training](#) scheduled for **1 March 2020 (2076/11/18), Sunday** from **9:00 AM at Union House in Anamnagar** (in front of Singha Durbar East Gate). The objective of the MIS training is to sensitize and orient all DSEs, M&E and Focal Engineers to accelerate in private housing reconstruction completion certificates supporting the requirement of the World Bank in loan/grant advance settlement process. The participants are requested to bring their laptop or tablet set including arrangement of travel allowance from their respective DLPIU-Offices.

Public notice pertaining to non-beneficiary: Public notice has been issued by NRA regarding non-beneficiaries list that has been identified after thorough analysis of statistics of resurvey and reverification conducted in 2075/2076 (2019/2020) and accordingly sent the public notice to all the DLPIU-GMaLI to notify individual beneficiaries who have been identified as non-beneficiaries. These identified non-beneficiaries can go through an appeal process in case of grievances and are not satisfied with the results by filing an application with required documents, either at DLPIU-GMaLI Office or directly at NRA Appeal Committee in Singh Durbar in Kathmandu.

Social Mobilizers Training as part of providing socio-technical assistance (STA) program in post-earthquake reconstruction: Social Mobilizers Training as part of providing socio-technical assistance (STA) program in post-earthquake reconstruction was implemented by NRA throughout the 14 earthquake affected districts to ensure that all earthquake affected beneficiaries, especially the vulnerable earthquake beneficiaries, reconstruct their houses in compliance with government building code standard. The CLPIU-Building, GMaLI, WB (World Bank), NSET, HRRP and CRS Nepal contributed in the design and roll out of training curricula, including resource persons support in the first phase at Sap Falcha in Kathmandu. The training was organized from 4-7 February 2020 for the social mobilizers and focal engineers selected from Kathmandu and Lalitpur districts, followed by Okhaldhunga (10-13 February 2020), Sindhupalchowk (11-14 February 2020) Dolakha (16-19

February 2020), Nuwakot & Rasuwa (23-26 February), and Gorkha (25-28 February). The training was focused on strengthening capacity and enhancing knowledge and skill of social mobilizers, focal engineers on social mobilization aspects. The participants were inducted on NRA policies and guidelines, including terms of reference (ToR) of social mobilizers. The training is being coordinated by DLPIU-Building in consultation with CLPIU-Building.

An update on Retrofit-Technical Working Group (R-TWG), 19 February 2020: An internal working session of R-TWG was organized at HRRP office to prepare the draft of norms for rate analysis and backup calculation for each item of the norms. During the working session, as requested from CLPIU/buildings, all organizations listed out calculation of norms for reference, and work division was done. Currently, all organizations are (HRRP, UNDP, NSET & Build change) working on finalization of draft of norms for rate analysis. For more information, contact Laxmi Prasad Bhatta, National Technical Officer at techofficer.national@hrrpnepal.org

Urban Recovery Sharing Session, 18 February 2020: The Urban Technical Working Group (UR-TWG) has progressed with the qualitative study analysis, and on the basis of it has developed a questionnaire for a quantitative study on prioritizing urban recovery challenges. These findings and the methodology for the study was shared at a larger Urban Sharing Session held on 18th February at DUDBC hall. The CLPIU-Building Project Director, Mr. Shyam Kishor Singh gave the opening remarks on urban recovery challenges. The Valley DLPIU Chiefs were present, and the meeting was chaired by NRA Executive Member Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha. Various partner organizations were present at the event and presentations were given by CRS Nepal, DRCN (Democratic Resource Center of Nepal), CARE and by the UR-TWG. The quantitative study is being jointly carried out by the UR-TWG and NRA and will be rolled out in the field through the beginning of March. Kindly contact sneha@hrrpnepal.org for more information on urban recovery and to participate in the UR-TWG.

Urban Recovery Compilations Publication: HRRP is in the process of creating a publication reflecting the key lessons learnt so far from the existing urban recovery efforts. This compilation will collate the dispersed learnings and challenges from partner organizations, donors, and other entities in the country's urban recovery, with the aim of its appropriation into the longer-term urban housing resilience in Nepal and beyond. This will be done through case studies focusing on 1) specific socio-technical processes such as selection of vulnerable beneficiaries, information management, urban recovery financing models etc. 2) projects focusing on reconstruction and retrofitting in urban areas. Partners are requested to contribute by writing to sneha@hrrpnepal.org for more information and to submit their interventions in urban recovery.

Orientation on preparation of institutional papers for International Conference on Nepal's reconstruction, 14 February 2020: As preparation for the International Conference, NRA organized an orientation session to partner organizations and briefed on the role of I/NGOs for the International Conference planned for November 2020. The Executive Members highlighted the importance of this international event and advised all the reconstruction partners to prepare an [institutional report in the given template](#), and share best practices and lessons learned out of Nepal's reconstruction process.

Future Resilient Cities in Nepal, 25 February 2020: A one-day workshop was organized to help generate a city-wide vision and action agenda to support resilience building in Kathmandu, jointly by Institute of Engineering (IOE), Tribhuvan University, Practical Action Nepal and King's College London. It was an activity of the Kathmandu Hub hosted by the Tomorrow's Cities programme [see <https://tomorrowscities.org/>] with funding from the United Kingdom's Global Challenges Research Fund. The participants included senior policy makers in housing, key infrastructure, land-use management and disaster risk management with responsibilities in Kathmandu and its local areas. Similar workshops are also being held in Quito, Istanbul and Nairobi.

DISTRICT & MUNICIPAL UPDATES

HRRP District Facilitation and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 27 Jan – 19 Feb 2020: during this period district facilitation meetings took place in Nuwakot (7 Feb), Dhading (10 Feb), Sindhupalchok (12 Feb), & Makwanpur (12 Feb, 20 Feb). Municipal level meetings took place in municipalities and wards across Sindhuli, Kavrepalanchok, Dhading, Sindhupalchok, Ramechhap, Okhaldhunga, & Solukhumbu. Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

In **Nuwakot**, it was reported that 1,026 households have still not signed the partnership agreement under the National Reconstruction Authority. So, the district facilitation committee decided to circulate the final notice in the Municipal offices to include those households who could not sign the PA by mid-January 2020.

In **Dhading**, the district coordination meeting focused on monitoring and evaluation of the reconstruction project to measure the overall performance. During the meeting it was informed that 13 people have returned the first tranche of 50,000 NPR while 1 has returned the second tranche amount of 150,000 NPR. Among the 14 households that returned the tranches, 8 were those who received double tranche from the Government and the partner organization and 6 were not interested in reconstruction. The meeting also discussed the Integrated settlement consisting of 56 private houses in Jwalamukhi Rural Municipality - 4. It was noted that no coordination was made with DLPIU - Building and GMaLI during the development of the integrated settlement. Further, the supporting and funding organization is also not in the list of district I/NGOs provided from National Reconstruction Authority. Also, the cost and technical specifications of the houses constructed have not been submitted to GMaLI and Building. It was reported that 469 people under the retrofit grant list have been converted to a full reconstruction list. It was also presented that 54 houses built in Rubi Valley Rural Municipality and 102 houses built in Nilkantha Municipality by Kadoorie (KAAA) have now fallen under the hazard risk area. As a way forward, the meeting also decided to remove the names of those households who have not signed the PA with the Government. It was decided that 163 quake damaged houses that were reported to be missing in the

reconstruction beneficiary list will be identified and verified at the local level and would be provided appropriate financial support if needed.

In **Sindhupalchok**, the district facilitation meeting decided to release the second tranche for 488 beneficiaries whose files were forwarded to DLPIU - Building after verification from local authorities before the end of Magh 2076 (12 February 2020). Regarding the files that have been submitted to DLPIU - Building after 13 February 2020, necessary decisions will be taken in correspondence with NRA Central, CLPIU - Building and CLPIU - GMaLI. In regard to the households that were not able to access the first tranche within the timeline due to geographical difficulties and other reasons, necessary correspondence will be done with CLPIUs and NRA Central for further guidance and action on release of tranche. Issues were raised regarding the houses that were rebuilt with support from partner organizations (POs), where some of the houses were left incomplete at the roofing stage due to POs' project phase out. This has left the beneficiaries in confusion about receiving the final tranche from NRA. The details of such beneficiaries have been forwarded to NRA for further process. However, no decision has been made yet.

In **Makwanpur**, the district facilitation meeting decided that the process for integrated settlement in Kailash Rural Municipality - 10 and Manahari Rural Municipality - 6 will be carried out by assigning work to site engineers and forwarding an official request to the Survey Department for further processing. Regarding the second tranche disbursement of those beneficiaries who applied for it before the end of Magh 2076 (12 February 2020), the amount will be provided. However, this will not apply to integrated settlement, vulnerable, and landless beneficiaries, and beneficiaries from resurvey and reverification. Files of households under landless, hazard risk areas, vulnerable and retrofitting category that have not been addressed through resurvey and reverification process and have not been able to get first and second tranches will be collected and sent to the Central NRA for further decision and a way out. The committee also requested DLPIU - Building to submit a full-fledged plan, progress report, list of beneficiaries who have received the completion

certificate, and the list of all beneficiaries who have not come under the PA agreement and those who have not received first tranche within three days. Similarly, the report with list of households that have received completion certificates and list along with reasons for not rebuilding the houses is to be submitted to the District Reconstruction Facilitation Committee and be verified from the committee and carried forward henceforth. Decision was also made on the reconstruction of houses by 1,287 landless beneficiaries who were not willing to relocate from their ancestral dwelling as presented in the list from CSRC (Community Self Reliance Center) to be allowed to reconstruct their houses in the place where they are currently residing as per the decision of Government of Nepal on 4 February 2019 in “Private Housing Grant Disbursement for Earthquake Affected (2nd Amendment) Policy , 2019”.

In **Sindhuli, Ward 6 Sunkoshi Rural Municipality (3 Feb); Tinpattan Rural Municipality (4 & 5 Feb); Ward 9 Kamalamai Municipality and Ward 2 Marin Rural Municipality (6 Feb)**, the meeting held at **Sunkoshi RM - 6** decided for onsite field visit of the houses built before the engagement of NRA engineers in the wards and also of those houses constructed by Nepal Red Cross Society. During the onsite visits, houses constructed before the deployment of engineers were provided with technical advice from the District Support Engineer and encouraged them to apply correction measures so that they will be eligible to access the remaining tranche. In the meeting held at **Tinpattan Rural Municipality**, houses to be retrofitted by UNOPS/Build Change were visited. It was observed that Build Change has started their preliminary work. Some of the houses retrofitted under NRA engineers’ technical assistance were found to be satisfactory and those beneficiaries were instructed by the District Support Engineer to perform the needed tasks as per the suggestion of the NRA engineers. Meeting at **Kamalamai Municipality - 9** focused on the issues of landless households which was hindering the reconstruction process in the ward. After the addressal of those issues it was seen that most of the people have started rebuilding their houses. During the meeting it was discussed to conduct a retrofitting training at masons’ level so that beneficiaries of retrofitting will also benefit from the training. In **Marin RM - 2**, the meeting

decided to request DLPIU - Building for providing a technical orientation to the engineers in the ward regarding retrofitting and reconstruction process.

In **Kavrepalanchok, Ward 5 & 6 Chaurideurali Rural Municipality (3 & 4 Feb); Ward 2 Bhumlu Rural Municipality (5 Feb); Ward 3 Mahabharat Rural Municipality (10 Feb); Ward 5 Khanikhola Rural Municipality (11 Feb)**, in **Chaurideurali Rural Municipality - 5 & 6** the discussion of the meeting was focused on 41 retrofit beneficiaries from ward no. 6 and 42 retrofit beneficiaries from ward no. 5 who seemed unwilling to start the process, the reason for their unwillingness seemed to be lack of awareness and orientation on the retrofitting techniques as they assume the SMM models of houses cannot be retrofitted. It was also observed that 11 retrofit beneficiaries have started retrofitting with technical assistance from the engineers. If technical assistance is provided, a significant number of households are willing to enroll in the retrofitting process. In **Bhumlu Rural Municipality - 2**, the meeting concentrated in the process for re-correction of beneficiary's name and sharing of the documents needed for the process. It also decided to seek assistance in case of those retrofit beneficiaries who have started new housing reconstruction and reached DPC level but whose decision on converting to reconstruction beneficiary from retrofit is still unclear. During a meeting at **Mahabharat Rural Municipality - 3** and **Khanikhola Rural Municipality - 5**, environment specialists from GMaLI presented the benefits of improved cooking stoves and its positive effects on health and natural safety to beneficiaries who have built earthquake resilient houses.

In **Dhading, Ward 5 & 6 Siddhalekh Rural Municipality (11 Feb); Ward 7 Nilkantha Municipality (12 Feb); Ward 6 & 7 Gajuri Rural Municipality (13 Feb); Ward 8 Tharke Rural Municipality (14 Feb)**, the ward level meeting at **Siddhalekh Rural Municipality 5 & 6** was focused on the discussion of reconstruction, retrofitting status in ward and reasons behind the slow progress of reconstruction status in the ward. In the meeting it was informed that among the 13 beneficiaries of retrofit in ward 6, 6 of them have started the process to be converted to reconstruction beneficiary, 1 has completed the retrofitting with the help of

Build Change and the rest are not in the condition to start the retrofitting process due to various reasons. It came to notice that 2 beneficiaries were benefited from the People's Housing Program (Janta Awas Karyakaram) of the Government of Nepal. Furthermore, it was notified that 29 reconstruction beneficiaries (RCB) who have received the first tranche have not started the reconstruction process. The main reason behind this was found to be family members staying abroad and/or single women with weak economic conditions. Regarding the vulnerable beneficiaries in the wards, it was decided that the new social mobilizers will start to find and verify the beneficiaries who can fall under the four categories of vulnerability in order to receive the NRs. 50,000/- additional top-up and the files of those vulnerables will be forwarded to DLPIU - GMaLI after the ward verification. Ward Level meeting held in **Nilkantha Municipality - 7**, focused on the redressal of 143 grievances among which only 26 were addressed from the National Reconstruction Authority. It was also informed that 48 RCB beneficiaries have not started the reconstruction even after receiving the first tranche. At the ward-level meeting held in **Gajuri Rural Municipality 6 & 7**, it was informed to the ward office that Housing Reconstruction Completion Certificate should be provided to all the beneficiaries who have completed the housing reconstruction. It was also brought to notice that 60 houses who received third tranche are yet to complete the roofing on their houses in ward 6. Ward Level meeting held in **Tharke Rural Municipality - 8**, brought to notice that several beneficiaries are unwilling to reconstruct their houses. Some of them who have already received first tranche are also not positive in building their houses and are ready to return the received tranche.

In **Sindhupalchok, Bhotekoshi Rural Municipality (10 - 13 Feb)**, it was reported that 36 households under the retrofit grant list have applied to be switched to full reconstruction beneficiary list but no decision from NRA Central has been made yet on those cases. Regarding the 53 displaced families, decisions of 20 families were made but no information has been received for the remaining families by the Municipal office. During the meeting, the case of Dwarka Foundation was also brought to notice in which the Foundation promised to build 156 houses but have not made any progress apart from starting a few houses, and also

there is no contact with GMaLI or local levels from the Foundation regarding the halt in the reconstruction process.

In **Ramechhap, Ward 9 & 5 Khadadevi Rural Municipality (18 & 19 Feb), in Ward No. 9**, 82 out of 89 retrofit beneficiaries have started reconstruction after dismantling their old quake damaged houses. These beneficiaries have applied to be converted to reconstruction beneficiaries from retrofit. However, the decision regarding this is still pending in the National Reconstruction Authority. The ward was informed that it is still not clear whether they will be converted as per the request and they have dismantled their houses at their own risk. Similarly, in **Ward No. 5**, it was noted that among 20 retrofit beneficiaries 8 have demolished and started reconstruction of new houses and 3 of them have already completed the reconstruction. All these beneficiaries have filed for change in beneficiary type from retrofit to reconstruction. There are some households who continue to use the quake damaged houses for storing food and other purposes due to insufficient space in new houses, so they are not willing to demolish the old houses. The District Support Engineer instructed engineers and social mobilizers to encourage those beneficiaries in the list of NRA who have started reconstruction but not dismantled their old houses to demolish those houses as soon as possible. Ward Chief expressed concerns regarding reconstruction of 4 vulnerable households in Ward 5 that were not included in NRA vulnerable list and are living in temporary shelter. Partner organizations have been approached for any support. Discussion with HELVETAS would be done for the possibility of funding, it guaranteed, ward engineers and masons would be mobilized for the reconstruction.

In **Okhaldhunga, Ward 1, 2 & 5 Khijidemba Rural Municipality (27-28 Jan); Ward 2 Likhu Rural Municipality (29 Jan); Ward 6 & 10 Champadevi Rural Municipality (30 Jan)**, in **Khijidemba Rural Municipality - 5** CRS-ORRP presented with the overall progress and its activities in the ward. It was decided to distribute certificates to the participants who passed level I examination of CTEVT (Council For Technical Education and Vocational Training) of 50-day mason training conducted by DCDC under funding of CRS-Nepal. The decision was also

made to make a direct monitoring of the activities done by ORRP. In **Khijidemba Rural Municipality - 2** activities of ORRP were discussed and monitoring of houses constructed during 50 days OJT and 25 days retrofitting training was conducted as well as low cost housing construction and livelihood support was also observed. In **Likhu Rural Municipality - 2** FORD/ORRP presented with the progress report of the project. It was decided that proper monitoring of the activities of FORD/ORRP will be conducted which will include low cost housing, OJT training and livelihood support. In **Champadevi Rural Municipality 6 & 10** the activities of ORRP were appreciated and requested to bring more projects which would uplift the living standards of the people in the ward. During the meeting the progress report of ORRP was shared with the stakeholders and was decided for monitoring of the various activities conducted during the project.

In **Solukhumbu, Sotang Rural Municipality (19 Feb)**, the meeting decided to make a request to any one partner organization to help build a model house and train masons for retrofitting as many houses in the municipal vicinity, as have been listed for retrofitting. However, due to lack of awareness and technical capacity the process has been obstructed. The meeting also decided that those houses built before the engagement of NRA engineers in the rural municipality although having received second tranche, due to beneficiary's unwillingness to correct their houses as per the suggestion of the engineers, are unable to receive third tranche. Hence, attention of DLPIU - GMaLI and DLPIU - Building regarding the process of such houses will be requested.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur, Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020
- 19 Feb 2020



Ward 2, Bagmati Rural Municipality, Lalitpur: the BMC single storey house with two rooms and flexible roof in attic. The homeowner has received all three tranches from the GoN.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 -
19 Feb 2020



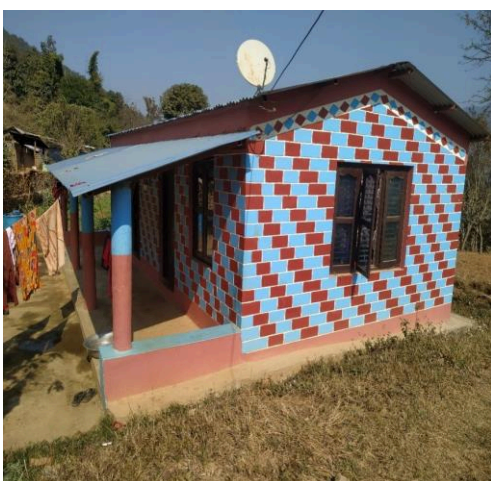
Ward 2, Marin Rural Municipality, Sindhuli: two storey timber structure. The house is currently being retrofitted with technical support from NRA engineers.

HRRP District Coordination Team Ramechhap Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 – 19 Feb 2020



Ward 8, Khadadevi Rural Municipality, Ramechhap: two storey stone in mud mortar with attic. The house was retrofitted using strong back technique by Buildchange as a retrofit demo house.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Gorkha Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 – 19 Feb 2020



Ward 1, Siddhalekh Rural Municipality, Dhading: two rooms, single storey, brick in cement mortar structure. The homeowner has received all tranches of Government grant. The total cost of construction was approximately 6 lakhs.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok, Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 – 19 Feb 2020



Ward 4, Chaurideurali Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: single storey, stone in mud mortar structure. The beneficiary has received all tranches from GoN.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu, Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 – 19 Feb 2020



Ward 6, Shankharapur Municipality, Kathmandu: single storey BMM structure under retrofitting grant list. The beneficiary had removed the damaged portion and added a block wall to cover the damage. DSE suggested adding bands to the house to be eligible for the grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur, Chitwan, Nawalparasi Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 – 19 Feb 2020



Ward 8, Manahari Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: Retrofitting beneficiary has received the first tranche of the government grant. Hybrid structure; at ground floor with load bearing stone in mud mortar and at first floor, timber is used. The house owner used splints and bandages and jacketing on the ground floor, and is using timber for bracing on the first floor. Technical advice is being provided by engineers.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Rasuwa Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 – 19 Feb 2020



Ward 3, Myagang Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: single storey, two room brick in cement mortar with attic. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the GoN.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Lamjung, Tanahun, Kaski, Syangja Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 – 19 Feb 2020



Ward 2, Aadhi khola Rural Municipality, Syangja: one storey, load bearing stone in mud mortar structure. The beneficiary has received the third tranche of the GON housing grant. The house has two rooms with CGI sheet roofing covered with straw.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 – 19 Feb 2020



Ward 5, Sunkoshi Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok: load bearing brick and cement masonry with two rooms without attic and CGI roofing. The homeowner has received second tranche and has applied for third tranche of the Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Okhaldhunga, Khotang, Solukhumbu, Monthly Report, 27 Jan 2020 – 19 Feb 2020



Ward 9, Likhu Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga: single storey with attic, two-roomed, stone in mud mortar house with RCC band. The construction of the house was supported by CRS/SS and was completed in OJT training within 45 days. The total estimated cost for the house was around NRs. 650,000.

FEATURED TECHNICAL STAFF CASE STORY

Featured Technical Staff Person, Kriti Gyawali, After the massive earthquake of April 2015 that caused a huge loss of life and property and affected lives of around 800,000 people, the National Reconstruction Authority was established with the concept of Build Back Better (3Bs). Among those affected by the earthquake 7,500 were identified as potential beneficiaries in Kathmandu Metropolitan City. To cope with the high demand of reconstruction and assist the beneficiaries, NRA appointed many technicians and engineers to facilitate private housing reconstruction work. I have been one of those lucky engineers to be serving the earthquake affected people to build resilient houses, said Kriti.

Prior to working in Kathmandu Metropolitan City, Kriti was assigned to a rural area of Tanahun district where she worked for a duration of 3 months as an engineer. Then she was transferred to Kathmandu Metropolitan City where she has been actively engaged as a Focal Engineer since April 2018 and is working dedicatedly in the urban housing development.

Kriti shares that her duty is not only to inspect houses and forward the files for tranche disbursement, but also to increase awareness about disaster and damage, building by-laws, and techniques for design and construction. She also remarks that housing reconstruction is a difficult task both in rural and urban settings as these are linked to a lot of technical as well as social issues. She finds reconstruction in Kathmandu a challenge as many of the beneficiaries in Kathmandu have mixed lifestyle of both, a rural and urban essence. Further, she adds that for the long-term sustainability of owner-driven private housing reconstruction, the focus should be on both technical as well as social assistance from various stakeholders such as the government, NGOs and INGOs

Kriti finds her job rewarding as she gets to work closely with local authorities and to interact and deal with the local people and solve their problems. She is happy to be represented as an engineer of NRA and working with the local government to facilitate the housing reconstruction process and conducting awareness programs to help build safe housing following National Building Code is a rewarding experience, she adds. She also shares her concerns regarding the reconstruction related issues in Kathmandu Metropolitan City that range from land issues, high-rise buildings to structurally non-compliant houses and many more.

Kriti said, "Training of Trainers (ToT) provided by CLPIU and Training for Instructors (TFI) provided by KMC were very useful and the training helped to develop the professional skills

that one needs as a trainer and as an engineer”. She says that the reconstruction process is going at a slow pace, but she is confident that it has achieved a fruitful result till date and has helped the people to build resilient houses supporting overall housing reconstruction in the country.

CASE STORY

Dambar Kumari Gubhaju, of Gokulganga Rural Municipality - 1, Chuchure in Ramechhap: Dambar Kumari Gubhaju is from Gokulganga RM-1, Chuchure, Ramechhap district. She is 61 years old. Dambar Kumari was in India with her sisters who worked there when the news of the devastating earthquake that shook Nepal on 25 April 2015. It was only after 7 days, Dambar Kumari came to know that her house was completely destroyed by the earthquake. With no house to live in, she stayed with her sisters in India completely oblivious to the knowledge and reconstruction process in the country. It was only after a year when she came back to Nepal, she came to know about the tranche process.



Dambar Kumari Gubhaju and her SMM house under construction at Gokulganga RM-1, Chuchure, Ramechhap. She shares her struggles during reconstruction as an unmarried single woman.

While the rest of the villagers were busy with reconstruction, she was living in a temporary shelter completely unaware of how she would be able to receive the tranches. With the help of the ward chief and NRA engineer, she was able to file for grievance and in 2017 was finally eligible for Government financial assistance for the reconstruction. Even though Dambar was able to receive the first tranche, she had no clue about how to manage the reconstruction of the house. She had no source of income and could barely manage the construction materials with 50,000 NPR she received from the Government. She was not able to borrow money from local people as they were not convinced that she would be able to payback given her status as a single woman with no source of income. Hence, she kept the tranche amount unspent and continued living in the temporary shelter.

Thanks to the HELVETAS door-to-door technical assistance that provided Dambar Kumari with necessary socio-technical support. Additionally, her cousins also managed a loan of 200,000 NPR from a local lender and cooperatives. Finally, she could begin the reconstruction of her house from September 2019.

Five years on and Dambar has been able to construct upto roof band level. She said the increase in material and labour costs have greatly impacted the reconstruction process. Other than some limited training and technical assistance, she has not received financial support from the Government or Partner Organizations. She has heard about the additional top up grant for the vulnerable to be provided by the Government but has no idea on how to apply or receive information for the process.

While she is waiting for the second tranche, all she is concerned about is her debt, for which she must pay 30% interest rate, but she is determined that she will pay it one way or the other.

Mrs. Goma Biskune, female mason and NRA reconstruction beneficiary of Nilkantha Municipality, ward no. 7, Pipalchap in Dhading:



Goma Biskune is a resident of Nilkantha-7, Pipalchap, Dhading district. She has five members in her family. As usual, she is busy with her household chores and works in her field. As a reconstruction beneficiary, she enrolled in the On-the-Job-Training conducted by NSET and completed the course under the NSET-Baliyo Ghar programme on 31 January 2018. During the training she learnt the construction mechanism of SMM houses as well as the norms of earthquake resistant structures. She also emphasizes the importance of adding horizontal and vertical components while constructing houses to make it earthquake resistant in her village. Although she was not a mason before, after the training she was motivated and encouraged to work as a mason. So, with support from other masons, she was able to reconstruct her own house.

Apart from her own house, she has not been involved in the reconstruction of other houses. This makes her sad. She feels sad not getting a job as a mason. She said women masons are not getting opportunities as men in housing reconstruction even though they have the same skill and capability as the male masons.

She has a strong desire to work as a mason and support her family. She would be grateful if the Government or any other organizations create opportunities for women masons where they can work and utilize their knowledge and skills in reconstruction, she added.

MEDIA COVERAGE & COMMUNICATION ON RECONSTRUCTION



[Baliyo Ghar | Episode - 175 | 23 February 2020](#): This episode discusses the case of Ms. Doma Sherpa, an earthquake beneficiary of Okhaldhunga undergoing retrofitting technology. This program was aired on Kantipur Television on 23 February 2020 at 6:30 & 10:00 PM.

NATIONAL PRODUCTS

[Monthly e-newsletter of National Reconstruction Authority January 2020](#)

HRRP PRODUCTS



[Palika Profiles \(Municipal reconstruction profiles\)](#)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



[Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack](#)

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32-earthquake affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month.



[Municipal dataset on Reconstruction](#)

[CSV, PDF](#)

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

PARTNER PRODUCTS

[Local level DRR/Resilience policy, plans, tools, trainings, workshops, and IEC /BCC materials including knowledge product update:](#) Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MoFAGA) is collecting information and data of the partners' support on local level DRR/Resilience policy, plans, tools, trainings, workshops, and IEC /BCC materials, as well as knowledge products from CBDRM Platform members. In this regard, platform members are kindly requested to share all the relevant information as per the attached [template](#) by 25 February 2020. This mapping exercise is expected to minimize duplications of the activities of partners and support to the Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA) and National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) as a whole. For more information, please contact Krishna Kumar KC, Focal Point CBDRM Platform krishna.kc@ifrc.org (Mobile: 977-9851240089)

[Urban Humanitarian Response:](#) This document is part of a series of learning products developed in partnership with the Global Alliance for Urban Crises. The Alliance, launched at the World Humanitarian Summit in 2016, is a global, multi-disciplinary and collaborative

community of practice. It brings together officials from local government, built environment professionals, academics and humanitarian and development actors to work towards systemic change in the way we enable cities and urban communities to prevent, prepare for and respond to urban crises.

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